# CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
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## EDUCATION

**Stanford Graduate School of Business** *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
*Dissertation Committee:* Hanno Lustig (chair), Juliane Begenau, Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru

**Barcelona Graduate School of Economics**, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

**University of Hamburg** *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Financial Intermediation, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

## JOB MARKET PAPER

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
   - Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade 2025 PhD Student Award

## WORKING PAPERS

1. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   - Winner of UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students

## WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *From Markets to Meters: How Index Investing Affects Electricity Prices*
2. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
3. *Does Index Investing Lower Expected Returns? Evidence From Option Markets*
4. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

## PRESENTATIONS (*SCHEDULED, $^c$CO-AUTHOR)

AFA Annual Meeting* *2026*

Johns Hopkins Carey Finance Conference, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (UHH)*, SFS Cavalcade, FIRS Conference, Four Corners Conference on Indexing, Investment Company Institute, Northeastern Uni Finance Conference, UIC Finance Conference$^c$, AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster) *2025*

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, GRASFI Conference, OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster), UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo), Citadel$^c$ *2024*

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster), UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School *2023*

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

## OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

**US Census Bureau** *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

**The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt** *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

**University of Chicago** *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

**Princeton University** *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

**University of Hamburg** *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Stanford Graduate School of Business**

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| *Base Finance*, TA to Juliane Begenau | *2022, 2023* |
| *Capital Markets and Institutional Investing*, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall | *2023, 2024, 2025* |
| *Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy*, TA to Amit Seru | *2022, 2023, 2024, 2025* |
| *Debt Markets*, TA to Darrell Duffie | *2021, 2022* |
| *Modeling for Investment Management*, TA to Steven Grenadier | *2023, 2024, 2025* |

**University of Hamburg**

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| *Macroeconomics 1 (UG)*, TA to Kristin Paetz | *2016* |

## SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

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| Shortlisted for Brandes Center Prize 2024 | *2025* |
| UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025 | *2025* |
| FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students | *2025* |
| SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award | *2025* |
| Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship | *2025-2026* |
| Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI) | *2025* |
| American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting) | *2025* |
| FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students | *2024* |
| Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize | *2024* |
| GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award | *2024* |
| Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business | *2020–2025* |
| Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University | *2018–2020* |
| Undergraduate and Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom | *2015–2018* |

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science
Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)

## BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

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| Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*) | *2011–2014* |
| Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant) | *2009–2011* |

## REFERENCES

**Hanno Lustig** (primary advisor)
The Mizuho Financial Group Professor of Finance
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**Amit Seru**
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